Table 10.7: ICMR Recommended Dietary Allowances for Fats

Group	Particulars	Visible fat (g/day)
Man	Sedentary work	25
	Moderate work	30
	Heavy work	40
Woman	Sedentary work	20
	Moderate work	25
	Heavy work	30
	Pregnant woman	30
	Lactating woman (0-6 months)	30
	Lactating woman (6 -12 months)	30
Infants	0 – 6 months	-
	6 – 12 months	19
Children	1 – 3 years	27
	4 – 6 years	25
	7 - 9 years	30
Boys	10 – 12 years	35
Girls	10 – 12 years	35
Boys	13 – 15 years	45
Girls	13 – 15 years	40
Boys	16 – 17 years	50
Girls	16 – 17 years	35

Phrynoderma is cured rapidly by the administration of linseed or safflower seed oil rich in EFA. Infants fed on an EFA deficient diet develop irritation and changes in the skin within a few weeks. The skin appear as dryness and desquamation with oozing in the folds. Diarrhoea may also occur, supplementation of the diet with linoleic acid helps to restore the skin to normal condition.

b) Effects of Excess of fat

1) Leads to Obesity because more than required calories are consumed. In addition, the excess carbohydrates are also converted to fat for storage in the body resulting in obesity.
2) Slows down digestion and absorption of foods.
3) Interferes with the absorption of calcium by combining with calcium to form an insoluble calcium soap.
4) Cause ketosis unless adequate carbohydrate is present to complete the oxidation of fat.

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